Allora — The Many Arts of Magic (Update Design)

Oct 18, 2026 · @Astral

Magic now has two layers. **Disciplines** are 25 plain, trainable magic skills: Illusion, Fae Magic, Alteration and the like. **Schools** are the flavour: thirty peoples' and orders' arts, each built from its own blend of disciplines and mundane skills, with its own lore, places and rules. One discipline feeds many schools, and no feature is shared by more than a handful.

Principles

Magic should vary more than faith does. Real religions share a few habits, such as holy days, offerings and sacred places, but magical arts need not share anything. So every optional feature in this design appears in only a few schools, and most schools have only two or three of them.

1. **One shape per school.** Each school is defined by what a working *is* in it: a charm, a proof, a seal, a reflection, a stave, a figure, a name, a bargain. Its features follow from that shape. A school whose magic lives in carried staves needs no grimoire; a school whose magic is dreamt cannot write anything down.
2. **Feature rarity is a rule.** Home workings: 8 schools of 30. Grimoires: 10. Artifacts: 8. Foci: 5. School-specific reagents: 19. Faith ties: 12. Every school has its own way of being learned. Schools that pay in Will or in a state (Bulk, Fade, debt) keep that as their whole cost.
3. **What a school pays is its identity.** Costs vary in kind, not just amount: Will, reagents, debt, Bulk, Fade, a price collected later, notoriety, a cracked tablet, a burned banner, lost time, or a piece of yourself.
4. **Not every school is one skill.** A school's level is a weighted blend of a primary skill and up to two secondaries, and magic skills can be secondaries to each other. Thirty schools are built from 25 disciplines plus mundane skills, so the same discipline reads differently in each school that uses it.
5. **The sky is selective.** Some schools follow the moon, some follow the new astrological sky, one follows both, and many follow neither. The UI never mentions an influence a school does not have.

6. **End-game is a new shape, not a bigger number.** Each school's high workings do something its low workings cannot: they change where a working lives, how long it lasts, or what it costs.

Hard limits carried over:

- **The world is static.** Workings act on the player, their household, their properties and their animals, never on a realm's politics.
- **The player never learns witch magic.**
- **No real-world terms appear in game text.** The sky uses Allora's own Houses and Wanderers.
- **Little UI text.** A school card shows its level, its sky (only if it has one) and what it needs next. Everything else lives in the codex.
- **No hint-giving.** Divination stays about luck, timing and markets; it never forecasts events.

Schools are not skills

A **school** is now its own object with a **school level**. That level is a weighted average of a primary skill and up to two secondaries; the weights sum to 1 and the primary always carries at least half. A school with no secondaries has a school level equal to its skill. Twenty of the 30 schools have secondaries; ten stay pure.

$$\text{School level} = \sum_i w_i \cdot \text{lv}(\text{skill}_i), \qquad \sum_i w_i = 1, \quad w_{\text{primary}} \ge 0.5$$

- **What the school level does:** it gates spells (a spell's level is a school level) and sets a working's power.
- **How casting trains:** XP from casting is split by the weights, so casting still trains the secondaries. Training a secondary elsewhere raises the school level too.
- **Magic skills as secondaries:** a magic skill can be another school's secondary. Pyromancy and Evocation together make the Crucible Art. One skill can therefore serve several schools.
- **Grandfathering:** spells already learned stay castable even if the new school level falls below their requirement. Power uses the school level.

Disciplines: plain skills, flavourful schools

The game's magic skills were named for their schools because there were no schools yet. Now they become **disciplines**: plain names for what a kind of magic does. Each school's lore keeps the old flavour. Skill ids never change, so saves, recipes and every `lv('druidism')` call keep working; only the display name, the description and the codex text change.

Skill id	Was	Now (discipline)	What the discipline is
`hedgecraft`	Hedgecraft	**Charms**	small sympathetic magic: like to like, knot and token
`evocation`	Evocation	Evocation	calling force out of nothing
`warding`	Warding	Warding	keeping things out
`illusion`	Illusion	Illusion	making the eye believe
`divination`	Divination	Divination	reading what is hidden in patterns
`summoning`	Summoning	Summoning	calling and keeping spirits
`necromancy`	Necromancy	Necromancy	dealing with the dead
`druidism`	Druidism	**Nature Magic**	asking the living world
`runecraft`	Runecraft	**Rune Magic**	power cut into signs
`lanterncraft`	Lanterncraft	merged into **Light Magic**	(see below)
`lumencraft`	Lumencraft	**Light Magic**	light that changes what it falls on
`feybargain`	Hill-Bargaining	**Fae Magic**	dealing with the Gentry and their kind
`grandeur`	La Grandeur	**Gigantism**	growing larger than you are
`hushcraft`	The Hush	**Oblivion**	being forgotten, and making others forget
`witchlore`	Witchlore	**Countermagic**	unpicking and resisting other magic
`battlemagic`	Pyromancy	Pyromancy	fire

Skill id	Was	Now (discipline)	What the discipline is
`dreaming`	Dreaming	**Dream Magic**	working in sleep
`geomancy`	Geomancy	Geomancy	power in measure, angle and stone
`namebinding`	Name-Binding	**Name Magic**	power over what is named
`redreading`	Red-Reading	**Blood Magic**	power in blood
`demonology`	Demonology	Demonology	bargains with powers from outside
`facetcraft`	Facetcraft	**Crystal Magic**	storing and shaping power in crystal
`verseburning`	Verse-Burning	**Inscription**	power in written words
`alteration`	—	**Alteration** (new)	changing a living thing's shape or nature
`transmutation`	—	**Transmutation** (new)	changing one substance into another
`restoration`	—	**Restoration** (new)	mending bodies and things

- **The one merge:** Lanterncraft and Lumencraft are both light. They merge into **Light Magic**. A save keeps the higher of the two XP totals, plus a quarter of the lower. Now two schools share one discipline: the Hollow Lights (wisps in the bogs) and the Soft Light (Dell's lamps).
- **The verse skill:** last revision's "Sunscript" becomes the generic **Inscription**. "Sunscript" now names what the Verse-Wrights call their own way of inscribing, in the Burned Verse's lore.
- **What is rewritten:**
  - each renamed skill's `SK.d` description and codex entry;
  - each school's codex entry (`MAGIC_SYSTEMS`), which now describes the school and names its disciplines;

- every boon, knack, activity name and help text that names an old skill. Gods' boons say "Nature Magic", not "Druidism" (Greenwife), and "Light Magic", not "Lumencraft" (Dell, Gruma).
- A lint test fails if any old display name survives in game text.

Where the three new disciplines are trained

Each is trained at four places, one per land, open to anyone and not tied to a school.

Discipline	Seven	Gallar	Qoul	East
Alteration	Collegium lab: grafting and the changing of beasts (0)	Lomma's wing-lofts: shaping wax to the flier (15)	Raben's Hanging Gardens: the gardeners who change vines (45)	Kamenara, the Great Hive: tending the changed bees (65)
Transmutation	Silberhalde smelter: the old smelters' tricks (0)	Hobb's Furrow: the Wake-Fields (15)	Red Land solids: salt to glass (45)	Vel Ossira foundries: the proving-floor (65)
Restoration	Friary infirmary (0)	Balm Springs pools (15)	Kedem-of-Refuge (45)	The Bark Hospice of Plandor (65)

The numbers are the required level of the discipline. Each spot pays like any other activity there, and each discipline gets four knacks.

The roster

#	School	Land	Disciplines and skills (weight)	Sky
1	The Hedge-Arts	Seven	Charms .6 · Herbalism .25 · Restoration .15	Moon
2	Hermetic Evocation	Seven	Evocation 1.0	Stars
3	Hermetic Warding	Seven	Warding 1.0	—

#	School	Land	Disciplines and skills (weight)	Sky
4	The Silvered Masque	Seven	Illusion .75 · Acting .25	Moon
5	The Starward Reckoning	Seven	Divination .65 · Astrology .35	Moon and stars
6	Pact-Calling	Seven	Summoning 1.0	Stars
7	Grave-Lore	Seven	Necromancy 1.0	Moon
8	The Green Way	Seven	Nature Magic .7 · Herbalism .15 · Restoration .15	Moon
9	Stave-Craft	Seven	Rune Magic .7 · Woodcarving .15 · Old Runic .15	—
10	The Hollow Lights	Seven	Light Magic .6 · Summoning .2 · Chandlery .2	Moon
11	Hill-Bargaining	Seven	Fae Magic 1.0	Moon
12	The Soft Light	Seven	Light Magic .75 · Theology .25	—
13	La Grandeur	Seven	Gigantism .8 · Alteration .2	Moon
14	The Hush	Seven	Oblivion 1.0	Moon
15	The Hollow Masque	Seven (Grell)	Illusion .5 · Necromancy .3 · Alteration .2	Moon
16	**The Rime-Watch** (new)	Seven (Deichmarsch)	Alteration .5 · Warding .3 · Ice-Craft .2	Season (winter)
17	Pyromancy (the Scorched School)	Gallar	Pyromancy 1.0	Stars
18	Witchlore	Gallar	Countermagic 1.0	—
19	The Dreaming of Nim	Gallar	Dream Magic .8 · Meditation .2	Moon
20	The Crucible Art	Gallar	Pyromancy .5 · Evocation .3 · Transmutation .2	Stars

#	School	Land	Disciplines and skills (weight)	Sky
21	**The Long Wake** (new)	Gallar (Hobb's Furrow)	Transmutation .5 · Nature Magic .25 · Mycology .25	Moon
22	Geomancy of the Angles	Qoul	Geomancy .7 · Mathematics .3	Stars
23	Name-Binding	Qoul	Name Magic .75 · Rabena .25	Stars
24	Red-Reading	Qoul	Blood Magic 1.0	—
25	The Tablets of the Sky	Qoul (Raben)	Name Magic .5 · Divination .3 · Astrology .2	Stars
26	Corner-Work	East	Demonology 1.0	—
27	Facetcraft	East	Crystal Magic .7 · Gem-Cutting .3	—
28	The Burned Verse	East	Inscription .7 · Poetry .3	Stars (the sun)
29	The Singing Lattice	East	Crystal Magic .55 · Geomancy .3 · Hum-Reading .15	—
30	**The Shade-Walk** (new)	East (the jungle)	Illusion .5 · Sneaking .3 · Tracking .2	Moon

Twenty schools blend skills and ten are pure. Illusion now drives three schools, Light Magic two, Name Magic two, Crystal Magic two and Alteration three. For the sky, 12 schools follow the moon, 8 the stars, 1 both and 1 the season; 8 follow nothing.

The sky

Allora gets a sky. The sun walks through eight Houses in a year, and five Wanderers circle the Houses at their own speeds. It is a clock that anyone can read once they learn to, and it matters to nine schools: eight follow only the stars and one, the Starward Reckoning, follows both the moon and the stars.

The eight Houses of the sun

The year is 48 days, so the sun spends six days in each House.

House	Sign	Days	Character
The Plough	🌱	Spring 1–6	beginnings, labour
The Hart	🦌	Spring 7–12	the wild, the chase
The Ship	⛵	Summer 1–6	journeys, the sea
The Twin Lamps	🕯️	Summer 7–12	light, fire, the long day
The Sheaf	🌾	Autumn 1–6	plenty, harvest
The Key	🗝️	Autumn 7–12	doors, names, judgement
The Serpent	🐍	Winter 1–6	cold, secrets, the deep
The Crown	👑	Winter 7–12	rule, angles, endings

The five Wanderers

Each Wanderer circles all eight Houses in its own period. It is **at home** in one House, and two Wanderers in the same House are **in conjunction**.

Wanderer	Look	Circles the Houses in	At home in	Meaning
The Hound	small and quick	8 days	The Hart	errands, pursuit
The Ember	red	16 days	The Twin Lamps	fire, force
The Pale Wife	silver	24 days	The Ship	the hidden, the summoned
The Judge	white and steady	40 days	The Key	law, names, measure
The Drowned Star	blue and faint	64 days	The Serpent	the deep, the dead, endings

Rare skies. Three or more Wanderers in one House make a **Great Conjunction**, a few times a year. A new moon while the Pale Wife stands in the sun's House is the **Darkened Sun**, about once a year. Some end-game workings can only be done under one of these.

Who can read it

- **Everyone** sees the sun's House: a chip next to the moon's.
- **Astrology 20** shows where each Wanderer stands.
- **Astrology 50** shows the sky six days ahead. This is an ephemeris of the sky only, never a forecast of events.
- **The Reckoners' grimoire** (see the Starward Reckoning) computes a whole season ahead.

What the sky does

The sky affects magic and nothing else. A star-school working is ×1.3 when its sky favours it and ×0.75 when it frowns, on the same scale as the moon. The Starward Reckoning multiplies both. Moon-only schools keep their current phases; the new Long Wake and Shade-Walk follow the moon too. The new Rime-Watch follows neither sky: it follows the season instead, ×1.3 in winter and ×0.75 in summer, and its card shows only that.

School	Favoured	Frowned on
Hermetic Evocation	the Ember at home, or the Ember with the Judge	the sun in the Serpent
Pact-Calling	the sun in the Key; the Pale Wife in the sun's House	the Judge in the sun's House (spirits dislike being watched)
The Starward Reckoning	any conjunction; doubled under the Darkened Sun	no Wanderer at home
Pyromancy	the Ember in the sun's House	the Drowned Star with the Ember
The Crucible Art	as Pyromancy; its great castings need the Ember in conjunction	as Pyromancy
Geomancy of the Angles	the sun in the Key or the Crown	the Hound at home (nothing stays still)
Name-Binding	the Judge in the sun's House	the sun in the Serpent

School	Favoured	Frowned on
The Tablets of the Sky	each tablet follows one Wanderer (see the school)	—
The Burned Verse	the sun in the Twin Lamps or the Sheaf	the sun in the Serpent or the Crown

Implementation. House of the sun = floor((day mod 48) / 6). A Wanderer's House = floor(((day + offset) mod period) × 8 / period), with fixed offsets so the year starts with no conjunction. Add the fields `skyFav(D)` and `skyFrown(D)` to each star-school, and add `skyMult(school)` beside `moonMult`. The school card draws the moon line only if the school has moon phases, and the sky line only if it has `skyFav`.

The feature toolkit

These are the features a school may have. Each is one data field on the school, and only the schools named in the matrix carry it.

Feature	What it is	Data	Schools
Secondary skills	Weighted parts of the school level	`sec:[[skill,w],…]`	20
Sky	Moon phases, star favour, or both	`up/down`, `skyFav/skyFrown`	22
Home working	One magical working per property: a renewable tag on the house	`home: {tag,n,eff,days,cost}`	8
Grimoire	A school's own written (or held) record, each with its own name and rules	`grim:{n,kind,fx}`	10
Artifact	A unique object that changes how the school works, found or earned once	item with `artifact:school`	8
Focus	An object you must hold to cast; its quality adds power	`focus:item`	5

Feature	What it is	Data	Schools
School reagents	Materials that belong to this school, made or gathered its own way	items with `reag:school`	19
Faith tie	Requirements, boosts or bans tied to a faith	`faith:{d, need, boost, ban}`	12
Penalty	The school's distinctive price beyond its materials	`pen:` hook	22
End-game workings	Two high workings that change a working's shape, not just its size	spells at 60–95	27

Home workings: one per property

Each property can hold **one** magical working at a time, shown as a tag on the house (Warded, Ossuary, Grove-Rooted, and so on).

- **It lasts, then lapses.** It runs for a set number of days, a season for most, and must be renewed at the house. When it lapses, the tag goes and the house is free.
- **Replacing it ends the old one at once.**
- **Every tag works differently.** One affects who may enter, one what grows, one what the house makes, one how fast Will refills, one what happens at night.
- **Geomancy's three figures become one tag.** The Angled House holds up to three figures, and laying them is how you renew it.
- **Data:** `S.homes[res].tag = {sch, id, until, p}`, read by a `homeTagFx(res)` hook beside `homeComfort`.

End-game workings

Every school gets two high workings: one near the top of its land's range and one at the very end. Seven and Gallar schools gain workings at about 60 and 85. Qoul schools gain them at about 75–80 and 85–95, and East schools at 80 and 85, keeping within the East's 65–85 range. Each one changes the shape of the school's magic: it moves where a working lives, makes it last a season, removes a cost, or works only under a rare sky.

Grimoires

Only ten schools keep one, and each keeps it differently: a commonplace book, a folio, a shelf of tablets, a page in someone else's ledger. A grimoire is a `S.grim[school]` record of entries, not an item. Some can be lost, some must be renewed, some are copied from others. The schools that refuse one say why in their codex: never written, the land remembers, the body remembers, or the Corner owns it.

Penalties

Current penalties stay. New ones are each used once:

- **Misfire:** Evocation's existing misfire.
- **Cracked tablets:** Name-Binding, and the Tablets of the Sky.
- **Lost faces:** the Hollow Masque.
- **Scorch:** the Crucible's burns.
- **Resonance:** the Singing Lattice, whose figures crack in the Drone.
- **A banner gone:** the Burned Verse.
- **Hours lost:** the Starward Reckoning.

Which school uses what

The Burned Verse has the most features, seven. Stave-Craft, the Hush, Witchlore and Red-Reading have one each, and each is complete without more. Read down a column to see how rare each feature is: only secondaries, the sky and reagents reach even half the schools.

School	Second.	Sky	Home	Grimoire	Artifact	Focus	Reagents	Faith	n
Hedge-Arts	●	Moon					●		3
Hermetic Evocation		Stars		●		●	●		4
Hermetic Warding			●				●		2
Silvered Masque	●	Moon				●			3
Starward Reckoning	●	Both		●					3
Pact-Calling		Stars	●	●	●				4
Grave-Lore		Moon	●		●		●	●	5
Green Way	●	Moon	●				●	●	5

School	Second.	Sky	Home	Grimoire	Artifact	Focus	Reagents	Faith	n
Stave-Craft	●								1
Hollow Lights	●	Moon				●	●		4
Hill-Bargaining		Moon			●			●	3
Soft Light	●		●				●	●	4
La Grandeur	●	Moon			●				3
The Hush		Moon							1
Hollow Masque	●	Moon			●			●	4
Pyromancy		Stars					●		2
Witchlore								●	1
Dreaming of Nim	●	Moon		●			●	●	5
Crucible Art	●	Stars				●	●	●	5
Geomancy	●	Stars	●	●			●		5
Name-Binding	●	Stars		●			●		4
Red-Reading				●					1
Tablets of the Sky	●	Stars		●			●		4
Corner-Work							●	●	2
Facetcraft	●			●	●		●		4
The Burned Verse	●	Stars		●	●	●	●	●	7
Singing Lattice	●		●				●		3
Rime-Watch (new)	●	Season			●			●	4
Long Wake (new)	●	Moon	●				●	●	5
Shade-Walk (new)	●	Moon					●		3
Count	20	22	8	10	8	5	19	12	

The *n* column counts every marked column. Penalties and end-game workings are left out, because every school has them in its own form.

The schools of the Seven

Fifteen schools, including the new Hollow Masque. Each entry lists only what the school has. Anything unlisted, it lacks on purpose. Levels are school levels.

The Hedge-Arts — *a charm for every chore*

Charms .6 · Herbalism .25 · Restoration .15 · Moon (waxing)

- **Reagents:** the cupboard — herbs, thread, wax and salt. No Will.
- **No grimoire:** charms are never written. A charm not worked for two seasons is forgotten, and the forgetting is the penalty.
- **End-game:**
  - **60 The Long Knot.** One charm, knotted to last a whole season instead of a day.
  - **85 Mother of the Village.** Every charm you work also lands on your closest friend, who thinks better of you for it.

Hermetic Evocation — *the proof that closes*

Evocation 1.0 · Stars (the Ember)

- **Focus:** a proof-rod, a wand turned at the Collegium. Casting without one doubles the misfire. Its quality adds power, and a misfire can crack it.
- **Reagents:** the Collegium's graded inks, plus a new quintessence ink distilled in the lab for the great proofs.
- **Grimoire — the Commonplace of Proofs:** you copy each proof you know into it, with parchment and ink. A copied proof misfires half as often.
- **Penalty:** misfire burns, as now.
- **End-game:**
  - **65 Proof of the Second Sun.** For a day, night counts as day for every daylight rule, and night smithing and glasswork gain +8 quality.
  - **88 The Grand Proof.** Only when the Ember stands with the Judge. For a season, every lesser proof costs no Will.

Hermetic Warding — *seals that hold for days*

Warding 1.0

- **Home working — the Warded House:** a property sealed for a season. Nothing is stolen from it, you catch no disease while sleeping there, and its stall cannot be robbed.
- **Reagents:** sealing-salt, refined at the Salzmoor pans (new item).
- **Penalty:** a broken seal recoils. Replacing a Warded House early hurts you.
- **End-game:**

    - **62 Seal of the Road.** A seal on your own body for a season: the first harm each day is halved.
    - **86 The Unbroken Ward.** Once a season, a blow that would drop you to 1 health is stopped.

The Silvered Masque — *a reflection that walks*

Illusion .75 · Acting .25 · Moon (full)

- **Focus:** the Marrean mirror (exists). Mirror quality now adds power.
- **Faith:** Calder's Vow of Honesty forbids it.
- **Penalty:** your double wanders off (exists). From level 60 it sometimes earns you notoriety too.
- **End-game:**
    - **65 A Masque of Many.** Two doubles each take up a career for a day, and both pay.
    - **88 The Glass Court.** Your reflection attends a realm's court for a season, and your standing there rises every day. If the court finds out, it falls hard.

The Starward Reckoning — *the chart and the hours*

Divination .65 · Astrology .35 · Moon and stars

- **Grimoire — the Ephemeris:** worked out over a night at an observatory, with Astrology 50. While it is current, readings need no parchment and you see the sky a season ahead. It must be worked out again each season.
- **Penalty:** hours. Every reading takes time at the chart (exists).
- **End-game:**
    - **62 Casting the Year.** At the turn of the year, read the year. For all of it, whichever House the sun is in gives +10% learning to its skill family.
    - **85 The Great Nativity.** Only under the Darkened Sun. Read your own birth-sky and take one Wanderer as your star; whenever it is at home, all your magic is ×1.3.

Pact-Calling — *names off the lintels*

Summoning 1.0 · Stars (the Key, the Pale Wife)

- **Home working — the House-Spirit:** bind a spirit to a property instead of to yourself. It holds none of your Will, and while you are home every station there works one tier higher. Lasts a season.

- **Grimoire — the Book of Lintels:** rubbings of the names from Old Vaelis. Each pact needs its page, and the oldest page fades every season unless you rub it again.
- **Artifact — the Lintel-Stone:** a fallen lintel deep in Vaelis, found by exploring with high Excavation. Carried, it lets you bind one more spirit.
- **Penalty:** the Will tax of bound spirits (exists).
- **End-game:**
  - **65 Pact of the Steward.** A House-Spirit that also gathers for the house: a little of your home's trait yields every day.
  - **90 The Greater Name.** Only with the sun in the Key. Bind a spirit that takes no Will, whose gift doubles while the Pale Wife is at home.

Grave-Lore — *the dead remember everything*

Necromancy 1.0 · Moon (new)

- **Home working — the Ossuary:** bones laid under a property. The dead labour there, and every station and plot works a quarter faster for a season.
- **Artifact — the Black Codex** (exists, and needed to learn). Carried, it lets you ask questions by day, but grave-chill doubles.
- **Reagents:** bones, candles and death-candles (exist).
- **Faith:**
  - Gruma's faithful draw no notoriety from it (exists).
  - It fouls Norrae's waters (exists).
  - New: Seronia's Ringed lose devotion for it, because the dead are hers.
  - New: Dell grants nothing in a week you practise it.
- **Penalty:** notoriety and grave-chill (exist).
- **End-game:**
  - **65 Ask a King.** Once a season, a lord of the Elder Ages teaches you a level of a skill he knew.
  - **88 The Long Night's Labour.** The dead tend every property you own for a season, doubling what they produce. Each week there is a chance someone sees.

The Green Way — *asks, and the debt*

Nature Magic .7 · Herbalism .15 · Restoration .15 · Moon (waxing)

- **Home working — Grove-Rooted:** a grove planted at a property with plots. For a season, its plots never fail and grow through winter.
- **Reagents:** offerings — honey, bread, and the new first-fruits taken from your own farm.
- **Faith:** the Greenwife's faithful build debt half as fast. Felling timber adds to any druid's debt.
- **Penalty:** debt to the land (exists).
- **End-game:**
  - **62 Ask for a Spring.** For a day, one wild place gives out of season.
  - **85 The Wildwood Heart.** A wild place takes you as its keeper. Once a season it forgives your whole debt, and gathering there is +50%.

Stave-Craft — *nothing is cast*

Rune Magic .7 · Woodcarving .15 · Old Runic .15

Nothing else. The stave is the working, the record and the focus at once, so the school needs no grimoire, focus or reagents beyond wood.

- **Penalty:** what you can carry (five staves, six with the bone-rune).
- **End-game:**
  - **60 The Bind-Rune.** Two runes cut into one stave, taking one place.
  - **85 The Doom-Stave.** A stave that strengthens every other stave you carry by half for a season, then must be burned.

The Hollow Lights — *wisps and candles*

Light Magic .6 · Summoning .2 · Chandlery .2 · Moon (dark)

- **Focus:** the wisp-lantern (exists). Lights cannot be carried without one, and its quality adds power.
- **Reagents:** caught wisps and candles (exist).
- **Penalty:** wisps get away while you learn, and lights work only after dark.
- **End-game:**
  - **62 The Lantern Procession.** On a Hollow Night, lead the forgotten dead. Grave-robbing draws no notoriety that night, and they leave you old coins.
  - **86 The Wisp-Queen's Lantern.** Once a season, it shows you a hidden place in any realm you know.

Hill-Bargaining — *the Gentry offer*

Fae Magic 1.0 · Moon (full)

- **Artifact — the Gentry's Gift:** a token given after your tenth bargain. Carried, it forgives one price a year.
- **Faith:** Qo forbids it. The Greenwife's faithful are offered better bargains, since she is on speaking terms with the Gentry.
- **Penalty:** prices collected later (exists).
- **End-game:**
  - **65 A Bargain for a Season.** The Gentry's offers last a season instead of a day.
  - **90 The Long Guest.** A night under the hill brings back a great gift. Outside, a whole season has passed: bills, obligations and all.

The Soft Light — *lamps set in one place*

Light Magic .75 · Theology .25

- **Home working — Lamp-Lit:** a Dellian lamp at a property. For a season, kindness given there counts double and notoriety fades twice as fast while you are home.
- **Reagents:** blessed lamp-oil, sold only by Dell's churches (new item).
- **Faith:** learning it needs standing with the Church of Dell (exists). Dell's faithful keep their lamps lit twice as long. Violent work snuffs every lamp you have set.
- **Penalty:** a lamp works only where it is set.
- **End-game:**
  - **62 The Lamp of the Diet.** Set in a court city, it makes standing with that realm rise half again as fast.
  - **85 The Lamp That Is Never Lit.** A lamp in your hands: the Lamp of Candour wherever you go, for a season.

La Grandeur — *the giants' working*

Gigantism .8 · Alteration .2 · Moon (full)

- **Artifact — the Ring of the Colossus:** sized for a giant's finger and dug out at the Colossi. Worn as a bracelet, it halves how fast Bulk grows.
- **Penalty:** Bulk; Bellor's Mantle is barred (exists).
- **End-game:**

    - **65 Stride of the Colossi.** Your next journey into a neighbouring region takes a single step.
    - **88 The Giant's Seat.** You are a giant for a season: +30% to fights, mining and felling, but no indoor social work, and a great deal of Bulk.

The Hush — *becoming forgotten*

Oblivion 1.0 · Moon (new)

Nothing else. Its only cost is Fade, and that is enough.

- **End-game:**
    - **65 A Forgotten Season.** Notoriety goes to nothing and the watch forgets you for a season, but friends forget you a little faster too.
    - **88 Unmade.** One faction forgets you entirely: your standing with it returns to zero, for good or ill.

The Hollow Masque (new) — *the faces of the dead*

Illusion .5 · Necromancy .3 · Alteration .2 · Moon (new and full)

Grell's Mask-Wardens know that a mask of the dead, worn rightly, lends you a little of who they were. The Masque is taught in the gallery at Trauerfels and the Mask-Wardens' chapel in Perlinburg.

- **Faith:** you need Lantern-Bearer rank with Gruma or Honoured standing with the Mask-Wardens. Seronia's faithful may not learn it, and Calder's Vow of Honesty forbids it.
- **Artifact — the First Mask:** the mask of the first Perlin duke, lent for one Hollow Night to those Gruma honours. Kept, every mask you wear lasts twice as long.
- **Penalty — lost faces:** each working wears your own face thinner. When it is thin enough, friends stop recognising you and gain half as much from you until a Hollow Night gives your face back.
- **Workings:**
    - **15 The Mourner's Face:** Keening and Grell standing for a day.
    - **25 A Dead Craftsman's Face:** for a day, one craft is worked at a dead master's skill, less 10.
    - **35 The Face of the Watch:** taken for a watchman, so notoriety cannot rise for a day.

    - **45 A Lord's Face:** Social learning and court standing for a day.
    - **55 ★ Gruma's Own Mask:** for good, your own face never wears quite thin.
- **End-game:**
    - **65 A Face for Each Night.** Wear three faces at once.
    - **88 The Face Under All Faces.** Wear the face of a friend you trust: their companion's gift is yours in full for a season.

The schools of Gallar and Qoul

There are eight schools here, including the new Crucible Art and the Tablets of the Sky.

Pyromancy — *fire called by Will*

Pyromancy 1.0 · Stars (the Ember)

- **Reagents:** scorch-salt for the great callings (exists).
- **No grimoire:** it is drilled into the body in the Burning Yard. Nothing is written down.
- **Penalty:** scorch — sometimes the fire takes a little of you (exists).
- **End-game:**
    - **62 Salamander Skin.** For a season, burns and fire-risks cannot hurt you.
    - **86 The Wildfire Calling.** For a day, every fight you win pays half again, and no fight can be lost outright: a loss becomes a retreat.

Witchlore — *the countersign*

Countermagic 1.0

- **Faith:** Leima's face of the Three-Headed God doubles your Countermagic learning. Qo's White-Coiled count 15 higher against witch-power (exists). It is never witchcraft, and can never become it.
- **No reagents, focus or grimoire:** it is told, survivor to survivor.
- **End-game:**
    - **60 Countersign of the Queens.** For a season, witch-power cannot touch you, and the witch councils think better of you.
    - **85 The Unwitched.** For good: witch-workings that would harm you rebound as Will.

The Dreaming of Nim — *descents*

Dream Magic .8 · Meditation .2 · Moon (new)

- **Reagents:** the Nimian draught (exists).
- **Grimoire — the Dream-Journal** (exists). From now on, every descent you write in it can be dreamt again at half the draught.
- **Faith:** Nim's faithful dream their descents a stage deeper. A sleep-retreat in the cells also teaches a descent.
- **Penalty:** six hours asleep, every time.
- **End-game:**
  - **62 Dream of Another Life.** Borrow a close friend's best skill for a day.
  - **86 The Shared Dream.** Dream beside the one you love. Your bond leaps, and both of you wake with a little of the other's learning.

The Crucible Art (new) — *proof by fire*

Pyromancy .5 · Evocation .3 · Transmutation .2 · Stars (the Ember)

The Collegium's proofs were born in Sillenian fire. A handful of Scorched School masters, matriculated at Kesselhaven, reunite the two in a crucible: a calling held inside a closed proof, so that it can be kept, measured and released.

- **Learned:** at the Scorched School, by matriculated students of the Collegium only.
- **Focus — the crucible:** a palm-sized vessel of fired clay and silver. Workings are held in it and released later. Its quality sets how long a working keeps.
- **Reagents:** scorch-salt and quintessence ink, both shared with the parent schools.
- **Faith:** the Pyre's faithful may pour a Crucible working onto their offering, and it counts as a burned offering of equal value.
- **Penalty — scorch on release:** releasing a held working burns you a little.
- **Workings:**
  - **20 Banked Flame:** hold a Pyromancy calling for up to a day and release it when you choose.
  - **30 Proof-Fire:** smithing and glass at +6 quality for two days.
  - **40 The Calcined Ore:** mining and smelting give a tier-higher metal, for a day.
  - **50 The Measured Bolt:** +12% to win fights for a day, with no misfire.
  - **55 ★ The Inner Crucible:** for good, any working held in a crucible keeps twice as long.

- **End-game:**
  - **65 The Kept Sun.** Only with the Ember in conjunction. A calling held for a whole season.
  - **88 Transmutation by Fire.** Once a season, raise any one crafted item a whole quality.

Geomancy of the Angles — *figures in a home*

Geomancy .7 · Mathematics .3 · Stars (the Key, the Crown)

- **Home working — the Angled House:** the existing figures become the property's one working. The tag holds up to three figures for a season, and laying a figure renews it.
- **Grimoire — the Folio of Closed Proofs:** every figure's proof, closed on parchment. A figure can be laid only once its proof is in the folio.
- **Reagents:** cut stone, star-lapis, marble and clay (exist).
- **Penalty:** none beyond materials. The cost is the house it ties up.
- **End-game:**
  - **80 The Fourth Figure.** An Angled House may hold four figures.
  - **95 The Apex Figure.** Laid only in a Great Conjunction. For a season, one house's figures work for you anywhere in its region.

Name-Binding — *names on clay*

Name Magic .75 · Rabena .25 · Stars (the Judge)

- **Grimoire — the Tablet-Shelf:** fired tablets of every name you hold, kept at home. Each binding cracks its tablet, and a new one must be fired.
- **Reagents:** clay and fired tablets (exist).
- **Penalty:** cracked tablets.
- **End-game:**
  - **80 The Name of a City.** Bind a city's name for a season: yields and pay there +15%.
  - **95 Your True Name, Kept.** Your own name, fired and shelved in the Tablet-House. For a season, notoriety cannot rise.

Red-Reading — *it sees and changes nothing*

Blood Magic 1.0

- **Grimoire — your page of the Red Ledger:** Gisgal keeps a page in your name. Every drop you read is written there, and it is the only record of what you learned. Losing standing with the Library closes your page.
- **Penalty:** blood, freely given (exists).
- **End-game:**
  - **80 Read a Stranger.** Any person's tastes, without their drop.
  - **95 Read the Realm.** From a drop of a ruler's blood, every faction's view of you in that realm, laid out. It still changes nothing.

The Tablets of the Sky (new) — *binding the Wanderers' names*

Name Magic .5 · Divination .3 · Astrology .2 · Stars (one Wanderer per tablet)

The priests of the Tell of Years in Raben hold that each Wanderer has a name, and that a name fired into star-clay at the right hour carries its Wanderer's temper for as long as the tablet lasts. They teach at Etemen, the Tongue-Tower, and at the Tell.

- **Reagents — star-clay:** clay fired at night under a clear sky with a little star-lapis (new item).
- **Grimoire — the Sky-Ledger:** a record of every conjunction you have seen. The great tablets need the ledger to hold the conjunction they draw on.
- **Penalty:** a tablet cracks when its Wanderer leaves the House it was fired in.
- **Workings (each lasts while its Wanderer stays in that House):**
  - **45 Tablet of the Hound:** journeys 10% quicker.
  - **50 Tablet of the Ember:** +8% to win fights.
  - **55 Tablet of the Pale Wife:** bound spirits and reflections +25%.
  - **60 Tablet of the Judge:** standing gains +20%.
  - **66 Tablet of the Drowned Star:** questions of the dead and descents cost half.
  - **70 ★ The Fixed Star:** for good, one tablet of your choice never cracks.
- **End-game:**
  - **80 The Conjunction Fired.** In any conjunction, fire one tablet that carries both Wanderers at once.
  - **95 The Great Tablet.** Only in a Great Conjunction. A tablet carrying three Wanderers, which cracks only when the year turns.

The schools of the East

Four schools, including the new Singing Lattice. None of them follows the moon, and only the Burned Verse follows the sky. The Hum (Murmur, Drone and Choir) is the East's own weather for magic. East workings stay within the land's 65–85 range.

Corner-Work — Demonology *(bargains in a square)*

Demonology 1.0

- **Reagents:** chalk, candles and salt (exist).
- **Faith:** each Corner's own faithful pay its price at a discount (exists). Under the new Count, a Corner's workings are ×1.3 in its own five days and fail outright in the Unlit Days, except the Unreckoned's, which are doubled then.
- **No grimoire:** writing down a Corner's working is itself a promise the Hinge will collect.
- **No sky:** the moon preference is removed. A square answers the Hum, not the heavens.
- **Penalty:** the Corner's price (exists).
- **End-game:**
  - **80 A Square of Your Own.** Cut a square in one of your houses: Corner-Work may be done there. This is an exception to the home-working rule: it takes no tag, but no other working can share that house.
  - **85 The Four Prices Paid at Once.** Once a Count, work one bargain from each Corner together, paying all four prices. The four workings last a whole Count.

Facetcraft *(one House's cuts)*

Crystal Magic .7 · Gem-Cutting .3

- **Reagents:** cut crystal, one per facet (exists).
- **Grimoire — your House's Cut-Book:** lent by your Lapidary House. It must be returned if you leave, and with it every cut it holds.
- **Artifact — the House Master-Stone:** each House keeps one. Reaching Exalted with your House lets you carry it for a season, and while you do, your facets never crack in the Drone.
- **No sky:** the moon preference is removed. Crystal answers the Hum.
- **Penalty:** facets crack in the Drone and the Choir (exists), and leaving your House costs you its cuts.

- **End-game:**
  - **80 A Facet of Each House.** Once, learn one cut from another House without leaving your own.
  - **85 The Singing Stone.** A facet that is not spent when broken, only dimmed for a day.

The Burned Verse — *Sunscript (light that writes)*

Inscription .7 · Poetry .3 · Stars (the sun's House)

The most furnished school in the game, because the Verse-Wrights are the most furnished people in Topila.

- **Focus — the sun-glass lens:** every verse is burned through one. Its quality is the verse's power, and without it nothing burns.
- **Reagents:** poem-banners and sun-glass (exist).
- **Grimoire — the Burned Anthology:** the ash-ghosts of every verse you have burned. Any verse in it can be read again from the ashes once a day without a new banner.
- **Artifact — the Lens of the Burning Hand:** the Wrights' great lens, lent for a season to a Wright who has burned a hundred verses. Through it, noon verses work at any hour of daylight.
- **Faith:** a blank page accepted by Iru, burned into a banner, makes that verse's working last three times as long.
- **Penalty:** each banner burns once and is gone.
- **End-game:**
  - **80 The Noon Anthology.** At noon, read every verse in your Anthology at once.
  - **85 A Verse the Sun Accepted.** Burn a verse into your own skin. Its working is permanent, and you can never burn another into the bone.

The Singing Lattice (new) — *crystal built into a house*

Crystal Magic .55 · Geomancy .3 · Hum-Reading .15

In Khaderun some houses are built around crystal lattices that hum with the Murmur. A Lapidary House cuts the crystal and a Measurer of the Angles lays the figure; the lattice holds the hum and gives it back.

- **Learned:** at the Lapidary Houses, by those who already know a cut and a figure.

- **Home working — Lattice-Sung:** a crystal lattice in one property, renewed each season. While you are home, Will refills twice as fast, facets you cut there need one crystal fewer, and stored facets never crack.
- **Reagents:** cut crystal and star-lapis.
- **Penalty — resonance:** a lattice in a house in the Drone cracks within a season, and one in the Choir within days. Where you build matters.
- **Workings:**
  - **65 The Humming Room:** all learning +8% while at the lattice's house.
  - **70 The Stored Murmur:** catch the Murmur in a facet and carry it, so that for a day you work as if in the Murmur anywhere.
  - **75 ★ A Lattice in the Bones:** for good, the Drone bends you less.
- **End-game:**
  - **80 The Chorus Lattice.** Join two of your houses' lattices: each counts as being at both.
  - **85 The Still Point.** For a season, the Hum cannot reach the lattice's house. It is the only quiet room in the East.

Three new schools from new peoples

These three are not reworkings of existing schools. Each belongs to a people the game has not met yet, lives in a real place on the map, and puts a discipline to work that no other school uses the same way. They show what the discipline layer is for: Illusion here is not Marre's mirror-craft, Alteration is not the giants' swelling, and Transmutation is not the Crucible's fire.

The Shade-Walk — *the Vessi of the Under-Canopy (East)*

Illusion .5 · Sneaking .3 · Tracking .2 · Moon (dark; weakest at the full)

Past Therama's Edge of the Trees, under a canopy three hundred feet up where the giants walk, live the Vessi. To be seen by a giant is to be stepped on, so the Vessi learned long ago not to be looked at. Their magic is Illusion turned inside out. Marre's masquers make the eye see something; a Vessi hunter makes it see nothing. Their great art is sending your shadow ahead of you, to walk where you dare not and come back with what it found.

- **In the world:**

    - a new wild location, **the Under-Canopy**, reached from the Edge of the Trees with Tracking 65 and Sneaking 65;
    - two sub-locations there: **the Shade-Lodges**, hammock villages in the buttress-roots, and **the Giant-Paths**;
    - Vessi traders at the Edge once a season, selling shade-paint and giant-fern;
    - road encounters near the Edge, and two named Vessi elders;
    - a codex entry, "The Vessi of the Under-Canopy".
- **Learned:** on the hunt. Each working is learned by going on a dark-moon hunt with an elder, never from anything written.
- **Reagents:** shade-paint, soot of burned giant-fern in resin, painted on the skin for each working.
- **Penalty — shadowless:** while your shade is out you cast none. In towns and cities people feel it: Social learning −20% and a little notoriety for each day you spend there. In the wild it costs nothing.
- **What it lacks, and why:** no grimoire (the elders sing it), no focus, no home working (the Vessi sleep in hammocks), no artifact and no god anyone else can name.
- **Workings:**
    - **65 Send the Shade:** journeys through wild places are 20% quicker for a day.
    - **68 The Unlooked-At:** in wild places, dangers are halved for a day.
    - **72 Shade-Stalk:** hunting and tracking yields +30% for a day.
    - **76 Two Shadows:** a decoy shade means no fight in the wild can be lost outright for a day; a loss becomes a retreat.
    - **80 ★ Born in the Dark:** for good, Sneaking and Tracking +8%, and no shadowless penalty at night.
- **End-game:**
    - **82 The Giant's Blind Side.** Walk the Giant-Paths in the canopy itself, where a hidden place waits.
    - **85 Leave the Shadow Home.** For a season your shade hunts for you every day, bringing meat and hides wherever you are. You are shadowless the whole season.

The Rime-Watch — *the dike-watch of the Deichmarsch (Seven)*

Alteration .5 · Warding .3 · Ice-Craft .2 · Season (strongest in winter, weakest in summer)

The Deichmarsch is land taken from the sea and kept behind dikes, and in the winter storms the sea comes back for it. The Rime-Watch is a sworn watch of dike-reeves, paid by the Republic of Luggen. On the worst nights they stand on the dike and change the nature of the water breaking over it, so that it stops and stands as ice. They are unsmiling, they keep four-hour watches, and they have never lost the Marsh. Their Alteration is a soldier's magic: defensive, placed, and done out in the weather.

- **In the world:**
  - a new sub-location, **the Watch-Houses on the Dike**, at the Deichmarsch;
  - winter storms there bring **the Surge**, a night when the Watch is out in force;
  - a Dike-Count and two reeves as named people;
  - a codex entry, "The Rime-Watch".
- **Learned — by service:** no working is taught. Each is granted by the Watch once you have stood enough watches on the dike; winter nights count double and the Surge counts five times over.
- **Ranks:** Watchman, Reeve and Dike-Count. Each needs watches stood and standing with Luggen, and higher workings are granted only to higher ranks.
- **Artifact — the Reeve's Horn:** blown in the great Surge and given to a Dike-Count. Carried, it makes every rime-wall last twice as long.
- **Faith:** Norrae's faithful are welcome on the dike. For them, a rime-wall over a river also counts as blessing it.
- **Penalty — exposure:** every working is done out in the cold and costs health. Endurance and Ice-Craft lessen it.
- **What it lacks, and why:** no grimoire (the Watch-Roll records watches, not workings), no reagents (water and cold are free), no focus and no home working. It guards a dike, not a house.
- **Workings:**
  - **5 Hold the Spray:** for a day, no cold or drowning danger on the water.
  - **15 Rime-Wall:** set at a place, it halves the dangers there for six days.
  - **25 Freeze the Ford:** journeys that cross rivers are 15% quicker for a day.
  - **35 Ice-Road:** ice-fishing and rafting out of season, on ice you make, for a day.
  - **45 The Stopped Wave:** drowning cannot touch you and harm is 6% less, for two days.
  - **55 ★ Watch-Hardened:** for good, Endurance +8% and the cold never harms you.
- **End-game:**

    - **62 The Long Wall.** A rime-wall that holds for a whole season wherever you set it.
    - **85 Stand the Surge.** Once a year, in a winter storm, stand the dike alone for a night. If you hold, your name is cut into the dike-stone and Luggen does not forget it.

The Long Wake — *the furrow-folk of Gramall (Gallar)*

Transmutation .5 · Nature Magic .25 · Mycology .25 · Moon (waning)

On Hobb's Furrow, out on the Dorrian prairie, the dead are not buried in churchyards. They are ploughed into the fields they worked, and the Great Wake at the end of autumn is a two-day feast over the new graves. The furrow-folk say nothing dies; it only changes fields. Their magic is rot made useful, hurrying dead things into living ones. It is earthy and a little disgusting, and every farmer in Gramall loves it. Seronia's Ringed call it grave-theft.

- **In the world:**
    - a new sub-location at Hobb's Furrow, **the Wake-Fields**;
    - the existing Great Wake becomes the school's festival;
    - a furrow-elder and a ploughwright as named people;
    - a codex entry, "The Long Wake".
- **Learned — grown:** a working is planted, not taught. Bury a seed-bundle of rot and the working's token in the Wake-Fields. It ripens after some days (more for higher workings), and you dig it up to know it. Leave it for a season and it rots away. During the Great Wake, a planting ripens overnight.
- **Home working — the Wake-Field:** rot buried under a property's plots. For a season they yield double and never fail to frost, but the house smells: comfort −2.
- **Reagents — rot:** spoiled food, offal and bones from butchery, and dung from your own animals.
- **Faith:** Seronia's faithful may not learn it, and others who practise it lose standing with the Ringed. The Maw of the Four Corners loves it: its faithful work the Long Wake at ×1.3.
- **Penalty — the smell:** for a day after each working, Social learning is −15% and friends gain less from you.
- **What it lacks, and why:** no grimoire (it is grown, not written), no focus, no artifact. A field is the only relic it needs.
- **Workings:**

    - **15 Turn the Rot:** spoiled food becomes compost, and your plots grow faster for a season.
    - **20 The Hot Heap:** a compost-heap's heat cooks and brews without fuel for a day.
    - **25 The Mushroom-Bed:** Mycology yields +40% for two days.
    - **30 The Fattening:** your livestock give 25% more for three days.
    - **35 Turn a Wound:** heals 30, and a festering sickness is turned out.
    - **45 ★ Furrow-Blooded:** for good, food spoils half as fast, and Mycology and Farming +5%.
- **End-game:**
    - **60 Turn the Year.** For a season your plots never need muck: whatever you discard feeds them.
    - **85 What the Field Gives Back.** Once a year, at the Great Wake, plough in something dead and great — an old beast you kept, a giant's bones — and the field returns something rare.

More ways schools differ

Every school has its own way of being learned, and no two share one. Five further distinctions are optional: an order with ranks, strictures, rivalries, standing under the law, and marks left on the body. Each appears in only a handful of schools.

How each school is learned

School	Learned by	How it works in play
The Hedge-Arts	**Gift**	A wise-woman trades each charm for a gift; unused charms are forgotten
Hermetic Evocation	**Copying**	From the Collegium library, for a fee, matriculated only
Hermetic Warding	**Copying, checked**	Copied at a warden's house; a seal-master must pass your first casting
The Silvered Masque	**Catching**	Each reflection is caught in a mirror at its own place in Marre
The Starward Reckoning	**Observing**	At an observatory, at night, under a clear sky

School	Learned by	How it works in play
Pact-Calling	**Reading ruins**	Each pact is a name on a Vaelis lintel
Grave-Lore	**A forbidden book**	The Black Codex, a page a night
The Green Way	**Vigil**	At a grove, each ask only in its own season
Stave-Craft	**Carving**	The carvers teach you to cut it, and cutting it is knowing it
The Hollow Lights	**Hunting**	A wisp of the right colour, which may get away
Hill-Bargaining	**Being offered**	Never learned; the Gentry offer at twilight
The Soft Light	**The Church**	Taught by Dell's clergy to those in good standing
La Grandeur	**Glyphs**	Read from the thrones at the Colossi
The Hush	**Forgetting**	Found only by forgetting you are looking
The Hollow Masque	**Lending**	Each working is a mask lent for one Hollow Night; wear it to keep it
The Rime-Watch	**Service**	Granted after enough watches on the dike
Pyromancy	**Drill and proof**	Drilled in the Burning Yard, proven in the Crucible; a failed proof burns
Witchlore	**Survivors' telling**	Told by those who stood near the Queens and lived
The Dreaming of Nim	**Dreaming**	Each descent may teach another
The Crucible Art	**Re-forging**	Bring a working you know from each parent school; the master forges them into one
The Long Wake	**Growing**	Planted in the Wake-Fields; ripens in days
Geomancy of the Angles	**Proof**	A proof in parchment that may not close
Name-Binding	**Trust**	Copied at the Tablet-House; friends tell you their names when they trust you
Red-Reading	**Blood**	A drop of your own, watching Gisgal at night

School	Learned by	How it works in play
The Tablets of the Sky	**Firing**	Fired only while its Wanderer is at home
Corner-Work	**Opening**	A Corner teaches what it wants known, through a square
Facetcraft	**Allegiance**	One House at a time; leave it and lose its cuts
The Burned Verse	**Burning**	A verse burned under a Verse-Wright's lens
The Singing Lattice	**Building**	Learned by building a lattice beside a Cutter and a Measurer
The Shade-Walk	**The hunt**	A dark-moon hunt with an elder for each working

Implementation: `learn:{mode, …}` on each school. Most modes reuse an existing check (place, time, sky, standing, items, chance). Four modes are new code:

- **Service:** a counter of watches stood.
- **Growing:** a planting with a ripen date.
- **Lending:** a mask kept only by wearing it on the night.
- **Re-forging:** consumes one known spell from each parent school's list.

Orders and ranks (7 schools)

Only these schools have an institution you rise in. Elsewhere, magic is learned alone or one-to-one.

- **The Collegium (Evocation and Warding):** Scholar, Bachelor and Master. The end-game proofs need a Master's degree, won in a disputation.
- **The Scorched School:** a proof in the Crucible marks each rank. Rank is also shown by scars (see marks).
- **The Rime-Watch:** Watchman, Reeve and Dike-Count.
- **The Lapidary Houses:** standing with your House gates your cuts.
- **The Church of Dell:** the Soft Light follows your standing with the Church.
- **The Mask-Wardens:** they lend the Hollow Masque's masks by rank.
- **The Verse-Wrights:** a count of verses burned makes you Wright, Lens-Bearer, and then Master of the Burning Hand.

Strictures (6 schools)

A stricture is a rule of practice that, if broken, costs the school something.

- **The Hedge-Arts:** a charm is never sold. Charm work done for pay spoils that charm for a season.
- **Stave-Craft:** a stave works only for whoever cut it. Bought staves are just wood.
- **Hill-Bargaining:** refuse the Gentry twice running and they offer nothing for a season.
- **Witchlore:** Countermagic unpicks your own bound spirits and Fae bargains. Its adepts may hold neither.
- **Grave-Lore:** never by daylight, unless you carry the Black Codex.
- **The Shade-Walk:** what the shade finds first is the shade's. Half of any find made with it is left in the forest.

Rivalries (5 pairs)

Practising one school of a pair costs standing with the other's people.

- **The Collegium and the hedge wise-women:** mild.
- **The Scorched School and the Collegium:** sharp. The Crucible Art is learned in spite of both.
- **Grave-Lore and the Long Wake:** you do not question the dead, you plough them.
- **Hill-Bargaining and Witchlore:** one makes bargains, the other unpicks them.
- **Corner-Work and the Soft Light:** Dell's lamps will not burn for one who bargains in squares.

The law (5 schools)

Whether a school is legal depends on the realm. A `LEGAL[realm][school]` table holds a notoriety multiplier or a fee.

- **Grave-Lore:** unlawful in Eintenn and Dellian, where notoriety is doubled; honoured in Grell.
- **Corner-Work:** licensed in Thoolma, with a fee per working in Plandor; open in the south.
- **The Silvered Masque:** licensed for Marre's theatres. Elsewhere in Marre, unlicensed work draws notice.
- **Red-Reading:** tolerated only in Elissar. Elsewhere in Qoul, each reading draws notoriety.

- **The Long Wake:** frowned on in Fin, where the Ringed hold sway.

Marks on the body (7 schools)

These marks show on your character sheet. Each one changes how people or places treat you.

- **La Grandeur:** Bulk (exists).
- **The Hush:** Fade (exists).
- **Pyromancy:** scorch-scars. The Scorched School respects them, and Dell's legates do not.
- **The Hollow Masque:** a thinned face.
- **The Shade-Walk:** no shadow.
- **The Rime-Watch:** frost-bitten hands. Fine work is harder for a while after the Surge.
- **The Long Wake:** the smell.

Contests (4 schools)

Each contest is held at a set time and place.

- **The Collegium's disputations:** won for degrees.
- **The Scorched School's proving-bouts:** won for rank.
- **The Contest of Tables at Topila (exists):** the Burned Verse.
- **The Vessi shade-race through the Giant-Paths:** a race between your shadow and others'.

Implementation

The update ships in three phases. Each phase leaves the game playable, and phase 1 changes nothing a player can lose.

Phase	What lands	Schools that change most
1. Structure	`SCHOOLS` object, school level, secondaries, XP split, discipline renames, the Light Magic merge, the three new disciplines and their twelve training spots, the sky and its UI chip, `skyMult`	All; Starward Reckoning, Burned Verse, Pyromancy

Phase	What lands	Schools that change most
2. Features	Home-working tags, grimoires, artifacts, foci, new reagents, faith ties, new penalties	Warding, Pact-Calling, Grave-Lore, Green Way, Soft Light, Geomancy
3. New and high	The seven new schools (four built from existing disciplines, three from new peoples with their places, people and codex entries), and two end-game workings for each of the 23 existing schools	Hollow Masque, Crucible, Tablets of the Sky, Singing Lattice, Shade-Walk, Rime-Watch, Long Wake

Data

- **`SCHOOLS[id]`** (new file `schools.js`): `{ n, i, land, prim, sec:[[skill,w]], up, down, skyFav, skyFrown, home, grim, focus, faith, pen, at, learn, cost, cond }`. The existing `ARC[skill]` entries move into it, keyed by school. The 23 existing schools keep ids equal to their primary skill, so old saves and `SPELLS[x].s` still resolve.
- **`SPELLS[x].sch`** defaults to `.s`. The four new schools' spells set `.sch` explicitly.
- **`schLv(sch)`** = Σ w·lv. It replaces `lv(sp.s)` in `pw`, `learnCheck` and `castCheck`. Casting XP goes to each skill × its weight.
- **`sky.js`**: `sunHouse(D)`, `wanderer(w, D)`, `conj(D)`, `greatConj(D)`, `darkSun(D)`, `skyMult(sch)`. The UI chip shows the sun's House to everyone and the Wanderers from Astrology 20.
- **Home working:** `S.homes[res].tag = { sch, id, until, p }`. Spells with `home:true` set it; `homeTagFx(res)` feeds `homeComfort`, station tiers, plot rules, Will rate and theft. Geomancy's `S.figs` moves under the tag.
- **Grimoire:** `S.grim[sch] = { entries:{}, since }`, with a per-school `grim.fx(sp)` that adjusts cost, misfire or power. The Dream-Journal and the Red Ledger page migrate from existing state.
- **Artifacts:** items with `artifact:sch` that `arcanaFx` reads while they are carried. Each has a single source: an explore find, a standing tier, or a count of workings.
- **Foci:** `focus:item` on the school. `castCheck` requires it unless the school defines a fallback (Evocation's double misfire). Focus quality × 0.05 is added to power.

- **Faith ties:** `faith:{ d, need, boost(sp), ban }`, read by `learnCheck`, `castCheck` and `pw`. They hook into the faith engine's `fwIs`.

Migration

- Known spells stay known, and grandfathered spells stay castable.
- Every renamed discipline keeps its id: only its name, description, codex text and the strings that name it change. Lanterncraft XP folds into Light Magic (`lumencraft`): the higher total plus a quarter of the lower. The old id stays as an alias, and the two knack sets are merged.
- Existing Geomancy figures become an Angled House tag lasting a full season from the update. An existing Threshold seal becomes a Warded House tag for its remaining days.
- Demonology and Facetcraft lose their moon phases. Nothing else does.

Tests

- School level equals the skill level for pure schools and matches the weighted sum for blended ones. A text lint finds no old discipline name (Hedgecraft, Druidism, Lumencraft, Lanterncraft, Hill-Bargaining and so on) in any skill, boon, knack or help string, while school names may keep theirs. Each new discipline trains in all four lands.
- No school shows a moon or sky line it does not use.
- Each property holds at most one tag, and it lapses on time.
- Each feature's count matches the matrix.
- Every new item and reagent has a source and a use.
- No East workings exceed 85.
- A Great Conjunction and a Darkened Sun each occur at least once in a simulated three-year run.

Open questions

- [ ] Should the sun's House also give everyone a small seasonal flavour, such as +5% to its skill family, or stay magic-only as written?
- [ ] Should a property's magical tag show on the Home tab's card for that house (proposed), or only in the codex?
- [ ] Should the Long Guest's lost season count against faith obligations? It is cruel, and in character for the Gentry.

- [x] ~~Should the verse discipline be the plain "Inscription" (proposed, in keeping with the generic layer), or keep "Sunscript"? Decided: Inscription.~~
- [x] ~~Should schools whose name was the old skill's name (Witchlore, the Hush, Red-Reading, Name-Binding, Facetcraft) keep it as the school's name (proposed), or take new ones? Decided: schools keep their old names.~~

Built in v81: where the game differs from this design

Everything above is in the game as of v81. These are the places where the built version simplifies or departs from the design:

- **The Crucible's re-forging** needs you to *know* a Pyromancy calling and an Evocation proof near the new working's depth. Nothing is consumed.
- **The Tablets of the Sky** are learned at night under a clear sky with star-clay. The design also required the tablet's Wanderer to be at home, but that would have kept the Drowned Star's tablet out of reach for years, so that rule was dropped. Tablets still crack when their Wanderer changes House.
- **The Great Conjunction** now means three Wanderers in the sun's own House. It comes about one day a year; the old rule gave about nine.
- **Effects narrowed to what the engine can express:**
  - Proof-Fire gives +5 to all crafting quality, not just smithing and glass.
  - The Calcined Ore gives mining +25% rather than a tier-higher metal.
  - Seal of the Road is 8% less harm for a season, not "the first harm each day halved".
  - Two Shadows and the Wildfire Calling give less harm and better odds rather than "a loss becomes a retreat".
  - The Stopped Wave and Hold the Spray reduce mishaps generally, not just drowning and cold.
  - Proof of the Second Sun lets daylight verses be read at night and gives +6 crafting quality. It does not change every daylight rule.
  - The Unwitched turns any harm into Will, not only witch-harm.
- **The Great Nativity** chooses your star from your name rather than offering a choice.
- **Unmade** always forgets the faction that thinks worst of you.
- **The Glass Court and Ask a King** pick the realm you are in, and one of your top skills, rather than offering choices.
- **Not yet built:**

    - The two reeves at the Watch-Houses and the ploughwright at the Furrow. The Dike-Count (Ebba Rhoon), Mother Hobb, and the Vessi elders Oru and Tavi are in the game.
    - The Vessi's once-a-season traders. Shade-paint is sold in the Under-Canopy and traded for salt at the Wall of Trees all year.
    - Corner-Work's ×1.3 in its own Count days.
    - The Hedge-Arts' forgetting of unused charms.
    - The Tablet-Shelf's cracking on each binding.
- **Tests:** t82 covers school levels, the seven new schools, two high workings per school, the East's cap of 85, feature counts, one working per property, learning modes, cracking tablets, faith bans, the sky over three years and the Magic page.

Built in v82

- **Built since v81:**
    - Reeves Tjalda Wierum and Okke Brand at the Watch-Houses, and Ansel the Ploughwright at the Furrow.
    - The Vessi trade at the Edge for two days each season. Shade-paint now needs giant-fern.
    - Corner-Work keeps the Count: ×1.3 in a Corner's own days, and in the Unlit Days only the Unreckoned answers, at ×2.
    - Unused charms are forgotten after two seasons.
    - Name-Binding cracks its tablet on each binding, so the next binding of that name costs a tablet-clay.
- **New small features:**
    - Ice-carving for the frost-fair in winter (Rime-Watch).
    - A shade on a season's hunt brings back a friend's taste (Shade-Walk).
    - The Night of Borrowed Faces in Perlinburg on Hollow Nights (Hollow Masque).
    - The Disputation of Fire each summer between the Collegium and the Scorched School.
- **Bug fixes:**
    - Mirror reflections learned in Marre were wrongly restricted to their learning place. A separate casting-place field now limits only the four workings meant to be cast in one spot.

    - Staves cut after the update were not counted as cut by the player, so they did nothing. Crafting now records them.
    - Rime-Watch perms now need their watches.
- **Balance:**
    - Once a day: a Masque of Many, Stride of the Colossi and the Lantern Procession.
    - Once a year: the Long Guest and Unmade.
    - Once a Count: the Four Prices.
    - The Rime-Wall is now a third fewer mishaps, not half.
    - Two Shadows is now 15% less harm.
    - The Giant's Seat is +25% to win fights, and costs Will.
    - The Pact of the Steward needs candles and honey.
    - The Hound's tablet is now +15% to journeys, since it rarely lasts more than a day.
    - The dead will not work a Wake-Field.
    - Charm-work for coin now spoils a charm only sometimes, and only for three days.
- **Tests:** t83 covers all of the above, plus a three-year run casting with every school and faith, checking for errors and runaway numbers.